Chung-Yen Lo

Department of Economics, Indiana University Bloomington | Wylie Hall 310 Indiana University Bloomington, IN 47405
cl86@iu.edu | chungyenlo.github.io

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Indiana University, Bloomington — Expected May 2027
M.A. in International Trade, National Chengchi University, Taiwan — 2018
B.B.A. in Banking and Finance, National Chinan University, Taiwan — 2016

Fields

Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics

Job Market Paper

Concentration without Greater Market Power? Evidence from a Sugar Refining Acquisition in the United States

Latest version

Abstract: This paper examines whether a merger between sugar refiners affects competition in the retail markets where their brands compete. Using NielsenIQ Retail Scanner data from 2016 to 2022, I study a 2021 acquisition between two U.S. sugar refiners. A difference-in-differences design comparing the Southeast, where the merging firms' refining capacity is concentrated, with other regions finds no relative increase in retail prices after the announcement. I then estimate a random-coefficients logit demand model and recover markups and marginal costs under multiproduct Bertrand competition. A counterfactual decomposition separates ownership and cost channels within a common demand environment. The ownership change raises equilibrium prices by only 0.03 percent and leaves markups, profits, and welfare essentially unchanged, while cost differences between the two periods lower prices by 0.4 percent and markups by 2.1 percent. The merging firms account for under 4 percent of retail volume, and substitution is spread across many brands, with private label dominating the category. The results suggest that a producer merger's competitive effects depend less on the change in producer concentration than on how much of the consumer-facing market the merging firms control and how readily buyers substitute between their products.

Publications

To make or to buy from a common supplier? Strategic considerations and welfare consequences

with Wei-Jen Wen and Wen-Chien Lee, *International Journal of Economic Theory*, Vol. 19(1), 2022

Working Papers

The Consumer Surplus Neutral Threshold of Cost Synergies for Horizontal Mergers in the Cournot Competition

Work in Progress

Health Shocks and Consumer Demand: Evidence from Household Ailments

Lobbying-Induced Misallocation and Aggregate Productivity

Fellowships and Awards

Graduate Assistantship, Department of Economics, Indiana University 2020-Present

Presentations

Hoosier Economics Conference, Indiana University April 2023
The Consumer Surplus Neutral Threshold of Cost Synergies for Horizontal Mergers under Cournot Competition

Teaching Experience

Instructor

Fundamentals of Economics for Business I, Indiana University Spring, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

Fundamentals of Economics for Business I, for Prof. John A. Schwendel Spring 2021–2024, 2026; Fall 2022–2023
Statistical Analysis for Business and Economics Summer 2025
Fundamentals of Economics for Business I, for Prof. Todd B. Walker Fall 2024
Fundamentals of Economics for Business II, for Prof. John A. Schwendel Fall 2021
Introduction to Macroeconomics Spring 2021
Statistics, for Prof. Nastassia Krukava Fall 2020

Research Experience

Research Assistant to the Regional Development Study Center, Chung-Hua Institution for Economic Research 2018-2019
Research Assistant to Prof. Wen-Chien Lee, National Chengchi University 2016-2018

Skills and Personal Information

Programming: R, Python, MATLAB, Maple, LaTeX
Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

References

Prof. Ruli Xiao (Chair)
Department of Economics
Indiana University
rulixiao@iu.edu

Prof. Yuki Ito
Department of Economics
Indiana University
yukiito@iu.edu

Prof. Emerson C. Melo
Department of Economics
Indiana University
emelo@iu.edu

Prof. Gustavo Torrens
Department of Economics
Indiana University
gtorrens@iu.edu

Last updated: October 13, 2026